

MIZORAM PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

**COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION FOR RECRUITMENT TO THE POST OF
ASSISTANT CONTROLLER OF MINES UNDER GEOLOGY & MINING,
COMMERCE & INDUSTRIES DEPARTMENT,
GOVERNMENT OF MIZORAM.
(MARCH-2026)**

GENERAL ENGLISH

Time Allowed : 3 hours

FM : 100

PART-A
(34 Marks)

*This section should be answered only on the Answer Sheet provided.
Marks for each question is indicated against it. Attempt all questions.*

1. Write a precis of the following passage, giving it a suitable title. **(14)**

Social media has revolutionized tourism by acting as a primary source for travel inspiration, research, and booking, with 75% of people using it to decide on destinations. Platforms like Instagram, TikTok, and YouTube drive “Instatourism” through visual content, heavily influencing travel trends and consumer decisions via user-generated reviews and influencer marketing.

Travelers discover new destinations, hotels, and attractions through visual storytelling, hashtags, and geotags. Tourism businesses in their turn use these platforms for immediate interaction, addressing queries, and improving customer service. These businesses also partner with influencers on social media since peer reviews build trust more effectively than traditional advertising.

One effect of the boom in social media usage is the prioritization of visual aesthetics, with millennials prioritizing a destination’s “Instagrammability”, that is, whether the planned destination is ideal for taking photographs and videos to be uploaded on social media. While this may boost tourism in lesser-known areas, it can lead to overtourism, environmental damage, and overcrowding when people flock to the most trending destinations.

2. You are the Assistant Controller of Mines posted in Siaha district. Illegal mining activities have been reported in a remote area under your jurisdiction. Preliminary verification indicates unauthorized extraction and transportation of minerals.

Write a letter to the Director, Commerce & Industries Department, Govt. of Mizoram reporting the situation, outlining the steps taken so far, and requesting additional manpower and technological support to curb the illegal activity. Sign as XYZ of ABC Locality (Veng), Aizawl **(10)**

3. Read the following passage, and answer the questions below:

As a kid, I spent my summers with my grandparents on their ranch in Texas... My grandparents belonged to a Caravan Club, a group of Airstream trailer owners who travel together around the U.S. and Canada. And every few summers, we'd join the caravan. I loved and worshipped my grandparents and I really looked forward to these trips. On one particular trip, I was about 10 years old. I was rolling around in the big bench seat in the back of the car. My grandfather was driving. And my grandmother had the passenger seat. She smoked throughout these trips, and I hated the smell.

At that age, I'd take any excuse to make estimates and do minor arithmetic. I'd calculate our gas mileage — figure out useless statistics on things like grocery spending. I'd been hearing an ad campaign about smoking. I can't remember the details, but basically the ad said, every puff of a cigarette takes some number of minutes off of your life: I think it might have been two minutes per puff. At any rate, I decided to do the math for my grandmother. I estimated the number of cigarettes per day, estimated the number of puffs per cigarette and so on. When I was satisfied that I'd come up with a reasonable number, I poked my head into the front of the car, tapped my grandmother on the shoulder, and proudly proclaimed, "At two minutes per puff, you've taken nine years off your life!"

I have a vivid memory of what happened, and it was not what I expected. I expected to be applauded for my cleverness and arithmetic skills. "Jeff, you're so smart. You had to have made some tricky estimates, figure out the number of minutes in a year and do some division." That's not what happened. Instead, my grandmother burst into tears. I sat in the backseat and did not know what to do. While my grandmother sat crying, my grandfather, who had been driving in silence, pulled over onto the shoulder of the highway. He got out of the car and came around and opened my door and waited for me to follow. Was I in trouble? My grandfather was a highly intelligent, quiet man. He had never said a harsh word to me, and maybe this was to be the first time? Or maybe he would ask that I get back in the car and apologize to my grandmother. I had no experience in this realm with my grandparents and no way to gauge what the consequences might be. We stopped beside the trailer. My grandfather looked at me, and after a bit of silence, he gently and calmly said, "Jeff, one day you'll understand that it's harder to be kind than clever."

What I want to talk to you about today is the difference between gifts and choices. Cleverness is a gift, kindness is a choice. Gifts are easy — they're given after all. Choices can be hard. You can seduce yourself with your gifts if you're not careful, and if you do, it'll probably be to the detriment of your choices.

(Extracted from a speech given by Jeff Bezos at Princeton University, 2010)

- (i) What did Bezos do that made his grandmother cry? (2)
- (ii) Why do you think Bezos' grandfather told him that it was harder to be kind than clever? (3)
- (iii) What lesson do you think Bezos intends to impart through his story? (3)
- (iv) Find words in the passage that have the same meaning as the following: (2)
 - (a) Something that happens as a result of something else
 - (b) A cause of harm or damage

PART- B
(66 Marks)

*All questions carry equal mark of 1 each. Attempt all questions.
This Section should be answered only on the OMR Response Sheet provided.*

Direction (Question Nos.1 - 10): Identify the part of speech of the underlined words:

1. These dogs are mine, not hers.
(a) pronoun (b) adverb
(c) adjective (d) preposition
2. Always help others when you can.
(a) pronoun (b) noun
(c) conjunction (d) adjective
3. Work hard else you will fail.
(a) conjunction (b) adjective
(c) adverb (d) preposition
4. He has already completed the job.
(a) adjective (b) preposition
(c) verb (d) adverb
5. I don't think I truly understand the true nature of love.
(a) verb (b) noun
(c) adverb (d) conjunction
6. I shall return within a week.
(a) conjunction (b) preposition
(c) adjective (d) adverb
7. She needs to study more.
(a) noun (b) adverb
(c) verb (d) pronoun
8. The little girl followed her mother everywhere.
(a) adverb (b) conjunction
(c) preposition (d) adjective
9. We have enough food to last us a month.
(a) adjective (b) preposition
(c) verb (d) adverb
10. The little boy dressed himself in his favourite pajamas.
(a) verb (b) adverb
(c) conjunction (d) pronoun

Direction (Question Nos. 11 - 16): Complete the following statements by choosing the alternative that best fits the context:

11. Which of the following is the most appropriate usage? "The new policies will _____ the administrative burden on small-scale miners."
- (a) decrease (b) alleviate
(c) subside (d) lessen
12. Despite the challenges, the department remained _____ in its commitment to transparency.
- (a) static (b) steadfast
(c) stationary (d) solid
13. The discovery of the new lithium reserve was a _____ event for the country's energy sector.
- (a) momentary (b) momentous
(c) memorable (d) mandatory
14. The new regulation acts as a _____ for innovation, forcing companies to develop cleaner extraction techniques to avoid heavy taxation.
- (a) stimulant (b) catalyst
(c) provocation (d) incentivization
15. The report was rejected because the data was _____; the numbers for January and February did not match up.
- (a) inconsistent (b) different
(c) wrong (d) slow
16. The company tried to _____ the villagers by promising jobs that were never actually created.
- (a) tell (b) force
(c) mislead (d) show

Direction (Question Nos. 17 - 26): Complete the following using the appropriate conjunction or preposition:

17. The beggar was sitting _____ the road.
- (a) beside (b) besides
(c) asides (d) aside
18. I congratulated him _____ his success in the examination.
- (a) over (b) in
(c) for (d) on
19. I am beautiful _____ I am humble.
- (a) though (b) hence
(c) yet (d) only
20. Many things have happened _____ we last met.
- (a) since (b) while
(c) as (d) until

21. The principal presided _____ the meeting.
(a) upon (b) unto
(c) over (d) at
22. The food was divided equally _____ the five boys.
(a) between (b) within
(c) amidst (d) among
23. I wore only a shirt _____ it was very cold.
(a) while (b) as if
(c) since (d) though
24. Complete this level, _____ you must forfeit the game.
(a) and (b) or
(c) hence (d) lest
25. He will come _____ I call him.
(a) however (b) slthough
(c) if (d) unless
26. Their floor is directly _____ ours.
(a) below (b) under
(c) beneath (d) underneath

Direction (Question Nos. 27 - 36): Change the sentences by converting the underlined word as indicated:

27. The soldiers fought bravely, but they were ultimately defeated. (to noun)
(a) The soldiers fought with braveness but they were ultimately defeated.
(b) The soldiers fought with brave, but they were ultimately defeated.
(c) The soldiers fought with bravery but they were ultimately defeated.
(d) The soldiers fought bravenly but they were ultimately defeated.
28. The late arrival of the Chief Guest completely disrupted the programme. (to Verb)
(a) The late arrive of the Chief Guest completely disrupted the programme.
(b) The Chief Guest arrived late and completely disrupted the programme.
(c) The late arrived of the Chief Guest completely disrupted the programme.
(d) The Chief Guest completely disrupted the programme by his late arrivance.
29. Unluckily, we were caught in a storm. (to adjective)
(a) We were unluckily caught in a storm.
(b) It was with lack of luck that we were caught in a storm.
(c) We were unlucky to be caught in a storm.
(d) We were caught in a storm due to unlucky.

30. She handled the diplomats with great ease. (adverb)
- (a) She handled the diplomats with easiness.
 - (b) She handled the diplomats with great easy.
 - (c) She handled the diplomats with easily.
 - (d) She handled the diplomats easily.
31. He laughed loudly, which startled the sleeping baby. (to noun)
- (a) He was laughing loudly, which startled the sleeping baby.
 - (b) His loud laughter startled the sleeping baby
 - (c) His laugh was loudly, which startled the sleeping baby.
 - (d) He laughed in a loud manner, which startled the baby.
32. The sweetness of her voice was captivating. (to adjective)
- (a) Her sweet voice was captivating
 - (b) Her voice captivated one sweetly
 - (c) She speaks sweetly and it was captivating
 - (d) Her voice is sweet and is captivating.
33. I want you to be firm in holding on to your beliefs. (adverb)
- (a) I want you to hold on to your beliefs firmly
 - (b) I want you to have firmness in holding on to your beliefs
 - (c) I want you to have a firm manner in holding on to your beliefs
 - (d) I want you to be firmly in holding on to your beliefs,
34. Even among a crowd, she felt lonely. (to noun)
- (a) Even among a crowd, she felt alone.
 - (b) Even among a crowd, she felt aloneness.
 - (c) Even among a crowd, she felt lonesome
 - (d) Even among a crowd, she felt a sense of loneliness.
35. He was wrongly accused of theft. (adjective)
- (a) He faced a wrong accusation of theft
 - (b) He was accused of theft in a wrong manner.
 - (c) He was wronged by the accusation of theft.
 - (d) It was a wrong accusation of theft.
36. I take great pride in your achievements. (to adjective)
- (a) I feel prideness in your achievements
 - (b) I am proud in your achievements
 - (c) I feel proudly about your achievements
 - (d) I am very proud of your achievements

Direction (Question Nos. 37 - 46): Answer the following as instructed:

37. Identify the type of sentence: "Please submit your verification documents by the end of the day."
(a) Assertive (b) Imperative
(c) Exclamatory (d) Interrogative
38. Which of the following is a 'Complex' sentence?
(a) The geologist found the sample and he labelled it immediately.
(b) Although the weather was harsh, the team continued the survey.
(c) The drilling process is slow but very precise.
(d) Monitoring the water level is essential for safety.
39. Identify the structure: "The motor started, and the lights flickered."
(a) Simple (b) Compound
(c) Complex (d) Compound-Complex
40. Identify the type of sentence: "The notification regarding the new mining policy has been published."
(a) Assertive (b) Imperative
(c) Exclamatory (d) Complex
41. Choose the sentence that functions as an 'Optative' sentence:
(a) I hope you pass the examination.
(b) May you have a successful career in the department.
(c) You will be a successful officer.
(d) Will you have a successful career?
42. Identify the underlined phrase: "The man with the gold medals is my uncle."
(a) Noun Phrase (b) Adjective Phrase
(c) Adverb Phrase (d) Verb Phrase
43. Identify the underlined phrase: "To win the national championship is her only goal."
(a) Noun Phrase (b) Adjective Phrase
(c) Adverb Phrase (d) Prepositional Phrase
44. Identify the underlined phrase: "He drove the car with extreme care."
(a) Noun Phrase (b) Adjective Phrase
(c) Adverb Phrase (d) Participle Phrase
45. In the sentence "The geologist visited the site because he wanted to collect samples," the underlined clause is:
(a) Noun Clause (b) Adverb Clause
(c) Adjective Clause (d) Co-ordinate Clause
46. Identify the underlined clause: "The workers who completed the training received a certificate."
(a) Noun Clause (b) Adverb Clause
(c) Adjective Clause (d) Conditional Clause

Direction (Question Nos. 47 - 51): Choose the correct answer from the given alternatives:

47. The officer said to the worker, "Show me your permit."
(a) The officer ordered the worker to show him his permit.
(b) The officer said to the worker to show him his permit.
(c) The officer ordered the worker that he show him his permit.
(d) The officer told the worker show me your permit.
48. He said to me, "Don't enter the restricted area."
(a) He said to me not to enter the restricted area.
(b) He told me that I don't enter the restricted area.
(c) He warned me not to enter the restricted area.
(d) He suggested me to not enter the restricted area.
49. The supervisor ordered the workers to wear their safety helmets.
(a) The supervisor said, "Workers, you must wear safety helmets."
(b) The supervisor said to the workers, "Wear your safety helmets."
(c) The supervisor said, "Workers wore their safety helmets."
(d) The supervisor told, "Please wear your safety helmets."
50. The father warned his son not to waste his time.
(a) The father said to his son, "You should not waste your time."
(b) The father said to his son, "Don't waste your time."
(c) The father said, "Not to waste your time."
(d) The father told his son, "Don't waste my time."
51. "I have submitted the report," said the clerk.
(a) The clerk said that he had submitted the report.
(b) The clerk said that he has submitted the report.
(c) The clerk said that he submitted the report.
(d) The clerk told he had submitted the report.

Directions (Question Nos. 52-56): Identify the phrase/ clause of the underlined words:

52. We cannot leave till it stops raining.
(a) adverb clause (b) noun phrase
(c) adjective phrase (d) noun clause
53. I do not know how to do it.
(a) adverb phrase (b) adjective clause
(c) adjective phrase (d) noun phrase
54. The book that you gave me is so fascinating.
(a) adverb phrase (b) noun clause
(c) adjective clause (d) noun phrase

55. She has been waiting for two hours.

- (a) adverb phrase
- (b) noun clause
- (c) adverb clause
- (d) noun phrase

56. What he said surprised everyone present there.

- (a) adjective clause
- (b) noun clause
- (c) noun phrase
- (d) adverb clause

Direction (Question Nos. 57 - 61): Complete the sentences with the most appropriate word:

57. The former Head was accused of _____ since so many of his relatives were appointed during his term of office.

- (a) plagiarist
- (b) familism
- (c) nepotism
- (d) polyandry

58. The late millionaire was a famous _____, who donated generously to charity.

- (a) philatelist
- (b) philanthropist
- (c) philanderer
- (d) philogynist

59. Life is so _____, with everything fading away so quickly.

- (a) eternal
- (b) effeminate
- (c) ephemeral
- (d) ineffable

60. His designs are derived from many diverse sources, and are therefore, very _____.

- (a) eclectic
- (b) erratic
- (c) eccentric
- (d) egregious

61. She was very _____ about her diet, opting to eat only locally sourced organic foods.

- (a) facile
- (b) fastidious
- (c) fascist
- (d) facetious

Direction (Question Nos. 62 - 66): Choose the most appropriate meaning of the idioms and phrases:

62. Barking up the wrong tree

- (a) to make a fatal mistake
- (b) to be suffering from
- (c) to covet others' possessions
- (d) to have a completely wrong idea about something

63. a rite of passage

- (a) a fee or favour given to someone for services rendered
- (b) an ancient ceremony held before a journey
- (c) an event marking a significant transition in someone's life
- (d) a written letter of introduction

64. to end in smoke

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| (a) to come to nothing | (b) to conclude something in a grand manner |
| (c) to criticise constantly | (d) to praise beyond one's efforts |

65. to harp on the same string

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|--|---|
| (a) to work in the same profession | (b) to have the same opinion with someone |
| (c) to repeat the same words again and again | (d) to learn from one's mistake |

66. to give oneself airs

- (a) to achieve success through one's own efforts, despite obstacles
- (b) to act arrogantly, and pretend one is more superior than one actually is
- (c) to act in such a way that it brings one's own downfall
- (d) to pretend one is useless, so as to avoid work

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